

FREE PATTERN

Free Single Crochet Dishcloth Pattern for Beginners

A true beginner pattern using only chain and single crochet — finishes in under an hour.

Updated 2026 • US terms • 6–7 in / 15–18 cm square



This is the same dishcloth from our [5 easiest first projects guide](#), written out in full so you can follow it row by row. It's built entirely from two stitches — chain and single crochet — and stays a flat, consistent square from start to finish, so mistakes are easy to spot and cheap to redo.

MATERIALS

- 1 skein worsted-weight cotton yarn (about 50–60 yards used)
- 5.0mm (US size H) crochet hook
- Scissors
- Yarn needle, for weaving in ends

ABBREVIATIONS (US TERMS)

ABBR.

MEANS

ch	Chain
sc	Single crochet
st(s)	Stitch(es)

Not sure what these mean in practice? Our [abbreviations glossary](#) covers US and UK terms side by side.

GAUGE

Exact gauge isn't critical for this project — a dishcloth is forgiving on size. As a rough guide, 14 sc and 16 rows should measure about 4in / 10cm square with a 5.0mm hook and worsted yarn.

NOTES

- Written in US terms. If you usually work in UK terms, see our [abbreviations glossary](#) before starting.
- The starting chain length below makes a roughly 7in / 18cm square. Chain a few stitches fewer or more for a smaller or larger cloth — just keep your starting chain an odd number.
- Cotton yarn is recommended over acrylic for absorbency and durability through repeated washing.

Pattern

FOUNDATION

Chain 21.

ROW 1

Single crochet in the 2nd chain from the hook, and in each chain across. Turn.
(20 sts)

ROWS 2–26

Chain 1 (does not count as a stitch), single crochet in each stitch across. Turn.
(20 sts)

Repeat this row until your piece is roughly square — about 26 rows for a 7in / 18cm cloth, checking against your starting chain edge as you go.

FINISHING

Fasten off, leaving a 6in / 15cm tail. Weave in both ends with a yarn needle.

Frequently asked questions

How much yarn do I need for a crochet dishcloth?

One dishcloth uses roughly 50 to 60 yards of worsted-weight cotton yarn, so a single 100-gram skein is enough for two or three dishcloths.

Why is cotton yarn recommended for dishcloths instead of acrylic?

Cotton is more absorbent and holds up better to repeated washing and scrubbing than acrylic, which can pill and doesn't absorb water as well. It's the standard fibre choice for anything meant to get wet and washed often.

How do I keep the edges of my dishcloth from curling?

Curling on a single crochet dishcloth is usually caused by tension tighter than the pattern's gauge. Try a slightly larger hook, and block the finished piece flat while damp to help it hold its shape.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.